

may create clothing, jewelry, or weapons and armor to adorn herself, or else forge entire homes and freeholds within the Near Dreaming for her use.

While some of these inanimate chimera exist purely in the Dreaming, many objects are tied to mundane reality by being fused with an object in the mortal world. A terrifying vorpal sword that sings as it cuts through the air might only appear as a humble walking stick. Changelings with the power and skill to craft such chimerical objects can make sure the object has a mundane counterpart so it might be used without attracting too much notice from mortals, thereby inspiring their disbelief and attracting the force of Banality down upon their heads.

Since chimera are the magical output of the changeling's imagination, the sky is really the limit for what can be designed. Faerie garb is usually an important part of a changeling's chimerical creations. Changeling will create any raiment they need, in designs that often harken back to their memories of their past lives, or whatever glimpses they might have held onto from Arcadia. This clothing and jewelry is known as *voile*.

A changeling may emerge from the Chrysalis wearing chimerical clothing, which can indicate a mark of who they were in a past life or their fae mien's particular skills. Those that emerge wearing chimerical armor can rest assured they have spent at least a little time in their past lives fighting as a soldier or guardian of one cause or another. Changeling who do awaken in garb from their past may choose instead to update their voile, and some changeling fashions can become outré, or even futuristic.

While chimerical clothing is apparent to other changelings, mortals do not see any of the voile. Instead, changelings advise their fledglings to continue to wear mundane clothing, as naked people attract a good deal of attention.

Once a changeling has outfitted themselves with voile, they can reach out and create more objects for themselves. Entire homes, luxury items, and weapons can outfit a changeling with everything they need to be safe and comfortable in the chimerical world. Each changeling's chimerical objects are as unique as their own dreams, their homes and hideaways tailor made to their imagination.

For the sake of avoiding undue attention, many changelings will overlay chimerical objects onto mortal ones, so that their chimera have a corresponding material component in the mortal world. This keeps changelings from attracting the attention of mortals around them when trying to use their chimerical objects. A mortal who notices a changeling riding in a chimerical flying car will only see a person flying through the air unaided if the chimerical conveyance doesn't have some kind of understandable and believable mortal component. Without that cover, the mortal will automatically disbelieve what they're seeing as outside of what they know to be real and the backlash of Banality triggered by that disbelief could crash down and harm the changeling, if not wreck that amazing flying car.

Inanimate chimera are created to be either short lived or long lasting, depending on the skill of the craftsperson and the amount of Glamour and work put into the creation. Most of these objects never have the possibility of establishing sentience,

but the longer lasting ones have a better chance to gain a mind of their own and escape into the Dreaming.

Animate Chimera

While inanimate chimera rarely achieve sentience, animate chimera are another story entirely. Animate chimera are creatures of imagination created to be playmates, friends, retainers, and confidants for a changeling. These chimera don't take human form, but many are created to look humanoid, or at least familiar, to the changeling that created them.

Unlike deliberately-crafted inanimate chimera, animate chimera almost always spring from the changeling's unconscious mind. Fueled by the need for a counterpoint, a friend, or a guide, animate chimera are created and offer aid, comfort, or companionship to a changeling in need. Animal companions are popular, as are faerie steeds or mounts, bedecked with all the finery a questing fae can imagine.

Other changelings create more complex creatures, ones that can speak or even fight. These constructs can be as simple as sparring partners or as complex as fully sentient and realized advisors to help a changeling sort out their thoughts. The more complex the chimera, however, and the more independent thought it has, the more chance that the creature can develop sentience and go rogue.

The danger rogue chimera pose to both changelings and mortals is real. Though mortals cannot see chimera, chimera can interact with the mundane world to do things like open doors or steal things, as long as a mortal is not looking. Chimera live on Glamour just like changelings and can even appear in the mortal world around powerfully creative humans, just like a changeling when revealing her true nature. It's for these reasons that rogue chimera, and especially monstrous chimera set loose on the world, can become so dangerous. The monster's claws can rend away pieces of a fae's mien and Undo a changeling if she isn't careful.

More dangerous than rogue animate monsters are the terrifying *nervosa*. Created by madness, *nervosa* appear like animals, weird creatures, or even humans, or can have no bodies at all. Like the madness that made them, these chimera are insane and utterly unpredictable. *Nervosa* come in an innumerable number of permutations, each one different then the last, and can develop from simple creatures into complex and intelligent dangers.

Some of the most dangerous chimera are the *noctnitsa*, born from the nightmares of changelings. They purposefully take the form of the changeling's worst phobias and, though they are mostly mindless, the *noctnitsa*'s intent is to torment and destroy its creator and others it comes across.

Other monsters take on more common forms, like fantastical creatures such as dragons, that break loose of their creator's controls to wreak havoc. Some of these creatures escaped ages ago and fled into the Dreaming to become ancient and truly terrifying spirits that torment, hunt, and can even destroy changelings. A chimerical monster's claws and teeth can rip into a fae's mien as badly as any weapon and can Undo a changeling just as quickly.